Breach of Protocol

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/82175801.

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General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Castaspella/Juliet (She-Ra)

Characters:
Juliet (She-Ra), Castaspella (She-Ra), Double Trouble (She-Ra)

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Canon Compliant, She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018) Season 4, Useless Lesbians, Attempt at Humor, SPOP Creative Flex (She-Ra), Quintuple Drabble, Awkward Conversations

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by Lost_in_the_mycelium

Summary

After Double Trouble is caught, General Juliet begins a thorough investigation to try and determine all of the spy's actions in recent months. This becomes surprisingly awkward when she interviews Castaspella.

Written for the SPOP Creative Flex April Fools Jester's 2026 prompt "shapeshifting."

Notes

I've had this silly idea for a while, and finally wrote it out for the "shapeshifting" prompt of the SPOP Creative Flex April Fools Jesters 2026 challenge. Enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

Juliet is surprised the first time Castaspella stops to talk to her, standing a little too close and dipping her voice when she calls her *general*.

It stirs something low in her stomach, but she is *on duty*, and Casta is an important figure and member of the royal family. She certainly has better things to do than make small talk. Naturally, Juliet's first thought is that there is an imminent security risk and the sorceress is trying to warn her in code. Juliet makes sure to keep a close eye on Casta after that, but no hidden threat emerges.

Casta may be the most notable, but many of her recent interactions have seemed off—subordinates referencing orders she never made, or mentioning seeing her in places that she hasn't been on her patrol. She knows everyone is tired and stretched thin. The Horde has been ramping up their assault, and lately they always seem to be one step ahead.

All the more reason not to let herself get distracted, especially not by foolish delusions about the non-tactical reasons a prominent official might exchange pleasantries with her.

After Double Trouble is caught, Juliet begins a thorough review of recent guard logs to try to piece together the imposter's movements. However, the depth of their twisted schemes doesn't become clear until she sees Casta again.

Juliet awkwardly catches the sorceress's attention, and the woman saunters over with a pleased smile. "Hello again, *General*."

"I'm not sure if you've been briefed on recent events, ma'am," Juliet says, trying to remain professional despite how the way the woman said her title felt anything but. "Over the past few months, a shapeshifting Horde spy has been regularly impersonating myself and other members of my guard. If you recall witnessing any irregular or suspicious behavior, please report it to me or one of my staff to aid with our investigation."

Casta looks surprised, then a little chagrined. "Oh my. It wasn't *you* who winked at me in the hallway during my last visit, was it?"

Juliet feels her face heat. What possible motivation could an infiltrator have for that, except to make a mockery of her? Was this an isolated incident or is she going to find out half the castle thinks she's developed a facial tic? "Certainly not, ma'am."

"Well…that explains some things," Casta says. "I'm sorry if I made you uncomfortable."

"There's no need to apologize," Juliet says. If anything, this new information shows that Casta was being *far* too understanding of a profound breach of protocol. "I'm sorry that my team's security failure put you in an...awkward position. We are implementing new procedures, and I can assure you that an incident like this will not happen again."

Casta gives her a small, almost wistful smile. "I trust your word on that. As you were, General."

This time when she uses Juliet's title, it's perfunctory and polite. Juliet accepts the dismissal with a bow, quickly burying any misplaced feelings of disappointed.

End Notes

DT noticed Casta eyeing your muscles and was trying to do you a favor, you silly lesbian.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!